DAVID COCKSON

HOPE IS NOT A STRATEGY.


```
davidcockson.com
  ├── blog.davidcockson.com      — technical blog
  ├── lccp-filter.davidcockson.com   — UKGC regulation filter tool
  └── scarlet-helix.davidcockson.com   — UKGC licence CSV filter

github.com/davidcockson-compliance
linkedin.com/in/david-cockson
```


Systems thinker. Finding constraints and designing controls. 8 years analysing complex regulatory systems | T-shaped Generalist | Cloud, Infrastructure & AI Systems.

GOOGLE CLOUD

- GCP Skills Boost
  Terraform
- GCP Skills Boost
  Kubernetes
- GCP Skills Boost
  Set Up a Google Cloud Network
- Google
  Fundamentals of Digital Marketing
- Google
  ADK Crash Course — Agent Development Kit

INDUSTRY QUALIFICATIONS

- ICA Advanced Certificate in Regulatory Compliance
- ICA Specialist Certificate in Money Laundering Risk in Betting and Gaming
- Award in iGaming — MQF Level 4

EDUCATION

- **University of Huddersfield**
  2010–2013
  Diploma in Law — tutoring, student representative, mooting society
- **Manchester Metropolitan University**
  2002–2005
  Certificate of Education, Dept of Economics — student representative

TRAINING

- Anti-Money Laundering & CTF
- Anti-Bribery
- Anti-Fraud & Payments Handling
- GDPR
- LCCP
- Remote Gambling — CMA Guide
- Responsible Gaming

TECHNICAL PROJECTS

Monitoring & Observability

- Full stack: Telegraf → Prometheus → Grafana across homelab and Contabo VPS
- Diagnosed silent cAdvisor failure (cgroup v2 + non-standard Docker root), pivoted to Telegraf Docker socket API
- Published Grafana community dashboard (ID 25012)
- Grafana Cloud setup (free tier, eu-west-2)
- Multi-cloud monitoring: Prometheus + Node Exporter + Grafana deployed to Contabo VPS (Ubuntu 24.04, Germany)

maps to → monitoring, observability, Prometheus, Grafana, incident diagnosis, multi-cloud

Linux & Containerisation

- Proxmox hypervisor running Ubuntu VM with 20+ Docker containers
- Services: Plex, Immich, Gitea, SearXNG, Nginx Proxy Manager, Portainer, Syncthing, and others
- Multi-stage Docker builds (Node/Vite → nginx:alpine) for project deployments
- systemd service authoring (Tailscale metrics proxy — Python HTTP proxy exposing client metrics to Prometheus)
- Linux Mint as primary dev environment

maps to → Linux, Docker, containerisation, virtualisation, systemd, process management

Cloud Infrastructure

- AWS: self-taught runbook methodology through 23 reps — click-ops → CLI → scripted automation → self-healing fleet (3 EC2 instances)
- LCCP Regulation Filter deployed to EC2 (multi-stage Docker build: Node/Vite → nginx:alpine)
- Contabo VPS: self-hosted AI stack (Ollama Qwen2.5 14B, Prometheus, Grafana, Syncthing) on Ubuntu 24.04, accessible via Tailscale mesh
- Multi-provider experience: AWS, Contabo, Cloudflare, GCP Skills Boost

maps to → AWS, EC2, CLI, multi-cloud, VPS management, cloud infrastructure

- Swedish Regulatory Framework
- CAP Responsible Ads: Gambling
- ICC Ethical Marketing & Advertising
- Introduction to Blockchain
- LivingWorks safeTALK
- GamCare Motivational Interviewing
- Betway LEAP Management Training

COMMUNITY

- Manchester tech meetups (Bet365, AI Data Hive/Matillion, Grafana/Autotrader)
- GFSC volunteer contributor (governance framework, distributed ops)

OTHER

- Homelab: Proxmox host, 20+ Docker containers, Tailscale mesh
- Photography (Darktable)

Python Development

- Code kata system: self-designed, multi-domain reps (AWS, Linux, networking) — same 7 concepts applied across 3 contexts per rep
- ARN decoder script — committed to public repo
- Discord server with 3 webhooks configured as alerting channel for monitoring stack
- Scripting across homelab and cloud automation tasks
- Google ADK (Agent Development Kit) crash course completed — AI agent framework

`maps to → Python, scripting, automation, webhooks, ChatOps, AI agents`

Terraform & IaC

- Runbook self-learning methodology: 4 reps completed, committed to pinned infra-practice repo
- Progression: single EC2 → User Data + IAM + CloudWatch → ALB + HTTPS → full production stack (ASG + Launch Template) in a single `terraform apply`
- GCP Skills Boost badges (Terraform, Kubernetes, Google Cloud Network)

`maps to → Terraform, IaC, HCL, ALB, ASG, GCP exposure`

Networking & Access Control

- Tailscale mesh networking across homelab, laptop, phone, and Contabo VPS
- Nginx Proxy Manager as reverse proxy for all services
- DNS management across multiple custom domains (Cloudflare)
- Labelled physical network infrastructure with structured cabling and surge protection
- Tailscale metrics proxy: custom Python service exposing network metrics to Prometheus

`maps to → networking, DNS, reverse proxy, VPN/zero-trust, infrastructure documentation`

CI/CD & Deployment Pipelines

- Blog (Hugo): GitHub Actions → Cloudflare
- Personal site: GitHub Actions deploy pipeline
- Scarlet Helix: GitHub Actions → Cloudflare Workers
- All projects use custom domains with DNS management

`maps to → CI/CD, GitHub Actions, deployment automation, DNS, Cloudflare`

Volunteer — Geeks for Social Change (GFSC)

- Infrastructure discovery: mapped an undocumented, distributed legacy server estate across Hetzner, Co-op Cloud, and Digital Ocean
- Drafted initial observability strategy (Uptime Kuma → Node Exporter → Grafana Cloud) collaboratively in HedgeDoc
- Iterated infrastructure review based on community maintainer feedback
- First external contribution: committed final technical proposals and system documentation to the organisation's public GitHub repo

`maps to → infrastructure mapping, Git collaboration, technical documentation, systems discovery, open-source community`

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Compliance Manager — `Gambling Commission of Great Britain`

July 2024 – Present

- Assessment of regulated gambling companies including casinos, betting shops, bingo, AGCs (in-person) and remote casinos, sportsbooks, bingo and B2B software development companies (online)
- Led all 2025 Software Development Licence assessments, including ISO 27001 reviews, Change Management evaluations, policy and procedure assessments, and governance interviews with C-level executives (CTO/CEO), Heads of Departments and SMEs
- Directed multiple successful regulatory actions in response to event-driven work based on incident reports; leading and advising on assessments triggered by sensitive whistleblowing and intelligence reports
- Support Policy teams on technical projects and reactive workstreams, managing high-stakes intelligence and whistleblower disclosures
- Utilise Microsoft Copilot, SharePoint and proprietary software to streamline regulatory reporting and maintain audit trails for complex assessment workflows

Regulatory Compliance Assurance Manager — William Hill (888 Holdings)

May 2023 – December 2023

- Recruited, trained and directed an Assurance team across Marketing Compliance, Technical Compliance and VIP/HVC schemes for 3 business units (UK & Ireland, International, US) spanning 22 regulated markets
- Established procedural frameworks and authored the Risk Matrix for the Group Assurance department; planned and executed all non-AML and SG assurance testing for 2023
- Coordinated operations for a 5-person international data and monitoring team and a 19-person testing team (Manila), providing task allocation and performance feedback
- Integrated Assurance into group regulatory and controls mapping with external entities including KPMG; authored the framework and supported delivery of RTS testing framework automation and the GB annual assurance statement
- Developed and delivered specialist training (Assurance Testing, GB Regulatory Actions, 3rd Party Risk Analysis, Marketing Compliance)

Compliance Officer — Allwyn UK (National Lottery)

September 2022 – March 2023

- Created Business Requirement Documents (BRDs) and provided compliance reviews for commercial and operations teams, including workshops with the outgoing licensee
- Led the design and build of the Compliance Monitoring Programme and control registers
- Advised Marketing, Retail and Product Development teams on technical implementation and regulatory alignment as a Subject Matter Expert
- Managed high-stakes relationships with Scientific Games and coordinated international Net Zero initiatives
- Led a joint Machine Learning development project with Oxford University, overseeing the bridge between academic research and commercial application

PREVIOUS ROLES

Regional Regulatory Compliance Manager — Betway Group Nov 2021 – Apr 2022
Managed 4 Compliance Managers across MGA, Belgium, Germany and NL. Built risk register, compliance monitoring, board reporting. Recruited and trained new staff.

Marketing Compliance Analyst — Pokerstars (Flutter International) Nov 2020 – Jul 2021
Marketing compliance across 15+ regulated markets, 3 gaming verticals. Created guidance, training and regulatory risk matrices.

Compliance Officer — Genesis Global Limited Dec 2018 – Nov 2020
Licence applications, casino launches, compliance monitoring development, gap analysis, regulatory reporting automation. Previously Risk, Payment & Fraud Analyst.

Legal & Compliance Officer — PlayAttack Affiliates Jul – Sep 2021
Marketing compliance across Sweden, MGA and Romania. Affiliate monitoring, licence applications, UKGC onboarding.

Case Handler — HSBC (PPI & PBA Departments) Aug 2013 – Aug 2017
Complaint investigation, documentation review across proprietary systems, procedure improvement, colleague training.